



YELLOW.AI (AI-BASED CUSTOMER SUPPORT)

• **RASHID KHAN**, CHIEF PRODUCT OFFICER & CO-FOUNDER • **RAGHU RAVINUTALA**, CEO & CO-FOUNDER
• **JAYA KISHORE GOLLAREDDY**, CTO & CO-FOUNDER

> **KEY INVESTORS** Lightspeed India Partners, Lightspeed Venture Partners, WestBridge Capital, Sapphire Ventures, and Salesforce Ventures

> **FUNDING** It has raised over \$102 million so far

► “Why can’t we chat with companies on WhatsApp like we do with friends?” This casual observation by two friends, Raghu Ravinutala and Jaya Kishore Reddy, back in 2014 spurred the idea for enterprise AI solutions provider, Yellow.ai. Originally started as Yellow Messenger—a chat platform for customers to engage with enterprises—the duo built the weekend project over four months. Their core team of three co-founders was complete when NIT Warangal student Rashid Khan joined the start-up four months after graduating. By March 2015, they had launched the product to a couple of B2C clients. Nine months later, they had 50,000 customers interacting with the product. Yellow.ai—which posted revenues of ₹215.25 crore in FY23 in India, and a loss of ₹89.85 crore—has since grown to service 1,000-plus customers such as Sony, Domino’s, Hyundai, Volkswagen, ITC Ltd, OYO and Skoda Auto across 85+ countries. The company says it earned \$30-40 million in annual global revenue. Their focus now revolves around humanising voice and chat conversations while eyeing expansion across multiple regions, including North America, Asia-Pacific, the Middle-East, and more. **BT**

— BY VIDYA S.

► **IN SEPTEMBER 2021**, Raghunandan G., former CEO of Taxi For Sure, wanted to address the challenges faced by individuals relocating between continents. That’s how Zolve was born. Simply put, the pain point that it is trying to solve is enabling access to financial products in the US for those that do not have a credit history or a social security number. This it does by focussing on providing cross-border neo-bank services, specifically addressing the hurdle of accessing financial products in the US. It offers a suite of products to assist immigrants in becoming financially prepared upon arrival in the US, reducing the financial disadvantages often faced by immigrants, such as higher interest rates and insurance premiums. In just over two years, Zolve has attracted over 500,000 users from various countries.

Originally planning a small launch, Zolve experienced unexpected demand, with nearly 90 times the expected users signing up. The annual revenue rate for the New York-based start-up is pegged at over \$6 million. The vast market potential, estimated at over \$650 billion with 40 million potential users, positions Zolve for significant growth. **BT**

— BY ASHISH RUKHAIYAR

ZOLVE (CREDIT ACCESS SOLUTIONS)

• **RAGHUNANDAN G.**, FOUNDER & CEO

> **KEY INVESTORS** Tiger Global, Accel, Lightspeed Venture Partners, Alkeon Capital Management, Founder Collective

> **FUNDING** \$55 million

